

Activity 21 Instruction Manual

Activity 21 | Topic 03 | C013 | Version v1.0

Purpose

A risk register with no responses is a list of things you will be surprised by. You will plan a response for every priority risk and check for the second-order effects that responses create.

Files used

- activity-guide.md and activity-guide.pdf - brief and source instructions
- prompts.pdf - reusable prompt and verification checklist
- mock-data.xlsx - safe fictional project data for practice

Expected output

A response plan for every priority risk, with owners, triggers and fallback plans.

Before you begin

1. Form the required group and assign one person to capture evidence.
2. Open mock-data.xlsx and review the title, note and column headings.
3. Open prompts.pdf beside your chosen GenAI tool. Do not upload confidential workplace data.

Detailed procedure

1. Confirm the eight response strategies. For threats: Avoid, Transfer, Mitigate, Accept. For opportunities: Exploit, Share, Enhance, Accept. Escalate applies to both when the risk is outside your authority.
2. Prompt GenAI: 'For each of these priority risks [paste], recommend a response strategy from avoid, transfer, mitigate, accept, escalate, exploit, share or enhance. Give the specific action, an owner role, the trigger condition, and the estimated cost of the response.'
3. Audit the strategy names. GenAI routinely labels a mitigation as an avoidance - avoiding a risk means eliminating the cause entirely, usually by changing the plan, not by reducing the likelihood.
4. Check the cost logic: a response costing more than the risk exposure it removes is a bad response. Prompt: 'For each response, compare its cost against the risk exposure (probability x impact). Flag any response that costs more than the exposure.'
5. Identify SECONDARY risks - new risks created by your responses. Prompt: 'What new risks does each of these responses introduce?' Transferring risk to a vendor, for instance, creates vendor dependency risk.
6. Identify RESIDUAL risk - what remains after the response is implemented. Every accepted residual risk needs a contingency plan and a contingency reserve.
7. Write a fallback plan for your top three risks: what you do if the primary response fails.
8. Define the trigger condition for each response - the observable signal that tells you to act. A response with no trigger is never implemented in time.
9. Update your register and share your top three responses with their triggers and fallbacks.

Use the supplied mock data

Copy only the rows needed for the current step and tell the model the data is fictional. If the model changes an identifier or number, reject the change and rerun with an explicit preserve-values instruction.

Quality control

- Every priority risk has a correctly-named strategy, an owner, an observable trigger, an identified secondary and residual risk, and your top three have fallback plans.
- Compare the first AI draft with the final human-corrected artifact and retain both as evidence.
- Label assumptions, decisions, owners and dates so another project manager can audit the result.

Troubleshooting

If the response is generic, add the project objective, constraints, audience and required columns. If arithmetic is inconsistent, request formulas and substitutions, then calculate independently. If a source cannot be opened, remove the claim or replace it with verified evidence.

Submission evidence

Submit the completed project artifact, the final prompt, a short critique of the AI output, and any screenshot or exported file required by the activity.